Charlie and the Chocolate Factory

By Roald Dahl

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

Suggested Roles: This is cast as non-gender specific – Any gender can plan any role. Pronouns when used remain true to the text.

ACTOR 1: Charlie, Narrator 1, Augustus' Mom, Veruca, Worker, Grandma Josephine, Violet, Crowd Member
ACTOR 2: Grandpa Joe, Wonka, Veruca's Dad, Grandma Georgina, Newspaper Boy, Narrator 2, Shopkeeper, Augustus

CHARLIE: **(Chapt 2)** Is it ***really*** true that Wonka's Chocolate Factory is the biggest in the world?

GPA JOE: ***True?*** Of course, it's true! Good heavens, I thought ***everybody*** knew that!

CHARLIE: And is Mr. Will Wonka ***really*** the cleverest chocolate maker in the world?

GPA JOE: My dear boy. Mr. Willy Wonka is the most ***amazing***, the most ***fantastic***, the most ***extraordinary*** chocolate maker the world has ever seen!

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 2: *Some things never change.*
ACTOR 1: *In 1964 when Charlie and the Chocolate Factory was first published, the greatest thing imaginable was gallivanting around a factory devoted entirely to making chocolate and other sweets.*
ACTOR 1: *And guess what? Over half a century later, that's still the greatest thing imaginable!*
ACTOR 2: *AND The willy Wonka Candy Company actually exists!*
ACTOR 1: *Laffy Taffy,*
ACTOR 2: *Wonka Bars and…*
ACTOR 1: *Everlasting Gobstoppers!*
ACTOR 2: *Follow us to a world of pure imagination . . .*
TOGETHER: *Charlie and the Chocolate Factory by Roald Dahl*

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

GPA JOE: **(Chapt 4)** You see, Charlie, not so very long ago there used to be thousands of people working in Mr Willy Wonka's factory. Then one day, all of a sudden, Mr Wonka had to ask every single one of them to leave, to go home, never to come back.

CHARLIE: He didn't do that! Why?

GPA JOE: Spies! All the other chocolate makers had begun to grow jealous, and they started sending in spies, pretending that they were ordinary workers. He shut the main gates and fastened them with a chain. Nobody sees him anymore. The only things that come out are chocolates and sweets.

*****

WONKA: **(Chpt 5)** I, Willy Wonka, have decided to allow children to visit my factory this year. These lucky children will be shown around personally by me and they will be allowed to see all the secrets and the magic of my factory. Golden Tickets have been printed and hidden underneath the wrapping paper of ordinary bars of chocolate. They may be anywhere – in any shop, in any town, in any country in the world. Good luck to you all, and happy hunting!

NARRATOR 1: **(Chpt 6)** The very next day, the first Golden Ticket was found [by] a boy called Augustus Gloop.

AUGUSTUS' MOM: *(With a strong German accent – Actor 2 pantomimes the role of Augustus eating while she speaks)* I just knew Augustus would find a Golden Ticket. He eats so many bars of chocolate it was almost impossible for him not to find one. Eating is all he's interested in. We're just as proud as anything!

NARRATOR 1: On the day before Charlie Bucket's birthday, the second Golden Ticket had been found. The lucky person was a small girl called Veruca Salt.

VERUCA'S DAD: *(Actor 2 pantomimes Veruca looking very sweet and angelic, while he speaks)* As soon as my little girl told me that she had to have one of those Golden Tickets, I started buying up all the Wonka bars I could lay my hands on -- sent

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

them directly to my factory. I had every worker in the place yanking the paper off those bars from morning till night. But three days went by and we had no luck. It was terrible!

VERUCA: *(The angelic child turns into a vicious, spoiled brat. Screaming)* Where's my Golden Ticket! I want my Golden Ticket! *(She pitches an amazing fit)*

VERUCA'S DAD: Well, I just hated to see my little girl feeling unhappy. Then suddenly on the evening of the fourth day . . .

WORKER: I've got it! A Golden Ticket! *(Actor 2 springs into fit mode as Veruca)*

VERUCA'S DAD: Give it to me quick! And I rushed it home and gave it to my darling Veruca. *(Veruca smiles angelically)*

*****

GMA JOSEPHINE: *(watching the news on television)* That's even worse than the fat boy

GMA GEORGINA: She needs a really good spanking.

*****

NARRATOR 1: That evening . . .

NEWSPAPER BOY: Golden Ticket found today! Only one more left!

VIOLET: **(Chpt 8)** *(chewing gum ferociously, she speaks loud and fast)* I'm a gum chewer, normally, but when I heard about these ticket things of Mr. Wonka's, I gave up gum and started on chocolate bars in the hope of striking lucky.

NARRATOR 2: **(Chpt 10)** During the next two weeks, the weather turned very cold. *(Charlie pantomimes)* There came a freezing gale that blew for days. Then one afternoon, walking home, his eye was caught by something silvery lying in the snow. It was a fifty-pence piece! *(Charlie snatches it up and races to the corner store)*

CHARLIE: **(Chpt 11)** *(Holding out his money to the shopkeeper)* One Wonka's Whipple-Scrumptious Fudgemallow Delight! *(the shopkeeper takes the money and hands Charlie the chocolate. Charlie tears off the wrapper)*

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

NARRATOR 2: And suddenly . . . from underneath the wrapper . . . there came a brilliant flash of gold *(Charlie responds in shock and awe)*

SHOPKEEPER: *(excited)* You've found the last Golden Ticket! Right here in my own shop! *(he looks around fearfully)* Take it straight home, quickly, before you lose it! Run! *(Charlie runs)*

*****

CHARLIE: **(Chpt 12)** *(Entering his house, waving the ticket)* I've got it! The last Golden Ticket! It's mine!

GPA JOE: *(startled awake)* You're pulling our legs, Charlie. Having a little joke?

CHARLIE: I am not! *(handing the ticket to Grandpa Joe*

GPA JOE: *(inspects the ticket closely and is silent for a moment, then)* Yippeeeeeeee! *(in all his elderly glory, the jumps up and does a victory dance)* The fifth and last Golden Ticket in the world! *(Charlie joins him in a victory dance)* You must get ready, my boy . . . for the biggest day of your life!

*****

NARRATOR 1: **(Chpt 13)** On the morning of the big day, all eyes were fixed upon the gates.

CROWD MEMBER: There he is! That's him!

WONKA: **(Chpt 14)** *(approaches the gates with a little skipping dance, spreading his arms wide)* Welcome, my little friends! Welcome to the factory! Who's first?

VERUCA: My name is Veruca Salt.

WONKA: My dear Veruca! How do you do? You do have an interesting name. I always through that a verruca was a sort of wart that you got on the sole of your foot! *(Veruca reacts)* But I must be wrong, musn't I. Please go in. *(He speaks to all the children as he ushers them inside)* Overjoyed! Enraptured! Enchanted! Excellent! Our tour is about to begin!

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

NARRATOR 1: *(both actors pantomime walking the path)* He turned right off the main corridor, then he turned left and left again. Then right. Then suddenly, Mr. Wonka stopped. There was a shiny metal door and on the door in large letters . . . THE CHOCOLATE ROOM.

WONKA: **(Chpt 15)** *(as he unlocks the door)* This is the nerve center of the whole factory. In we go! But do be careful! Don't get over-excited! Keep very calm! *(Actor 1 pantomimes the excitement of the children as they see the room)* Isn't it teriffic? A great brown river! There's enough chocolate in there to fill every bathtub in the entire country! *(Actor 1 notices the grass and bends to pick up a blade)* The grass is made of a new kind of soft, minty sugar that I've just invented! I call it swudge! Try a blade! It's delectable. *(Actor 1 eats and reacts)*

VERUCA: Look over there! It's a little person! Down there below the waterfall! Aren't they fantastic!

WONKA: They're Oompa-Loompas – **(Chpt 16)** Imported direct from Loompaland. They love dancing and music.

VERUCA: Daddy! I want an Oompa-Loompa!

AUGUSTUS: *(uninterested in the little men, he sneaks down to the edge of the river and begins scooping the melted chocolate into his mouth as fast as he can)*

AGUSTUS' MOM: *(Popping open her umbrella)* Augustus, sweetheart, I don't think you had better do that!

WONKA: **(Chpt 17)** Oh, no! My chocolate must be untouched by human hands!

AUGUSTUS' MOM: Augustus! Come away from that river at once!

AUGUSTUS: This stuff is fabulous! *(Augustus shrieks as he falls into the river)* Help! Help!

AUGUSTUS' MOM: Don't just stand there! Do something! *(She panics, closes her umbrella and waves it around furiously; then both Actors watch Augustus' progression down the river and up through large glass pipes until he disappears)*

WONKA: *(Remaining calm, he turns and snaps his fingers)* Keep calm, my dear lady. There

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

is no danger. Augustus has gone on a little journey, that's all.

AUGUSTUS' MOM: He'll be made into fudge. They'll be selling him by the pound all over the country tomorrow! *(She strikes Mr. Wonka with her umbrella)*

WONKA: *(Fending off the attack)* Never! I wouldn't allow it! The taste would be terrible. Just imagine it – Augustus-flavored chocolate-coated Gloop! No one would buy it. *(he turns to an Oompa Looma, who is no taller than his knee)* Take Mrs. Gloop to the Fudge Room and help find Augustus . . . *(to the tour group)* Off we go!

*****

NARRATOR 1: **(Chpt 18)** A steamy mist was rising from the chocolate river and out of the mist there appeared a most fantastic pink, boiled-sweet boat.

WONKA: *(ushers the tour onto the boat)* Please do not lick the boat. It'll only make it sticky.

VERUCA: Daddy, I want a boat like this! Buy me a big pink boiled-sweet boat exactly like Mr. Wonka's! And I want lots of Oompa-Loompas to row me about, and I want a chocolate river and I want . . . I want . . .

GPA JOE: *(whispering to Charlie as Veruca silently continues her list of wants)* She wants a good kick in the pants. *(the boat suddenly picks up speed and the actors react for a few seconds)*

WONKA: *(waving his hands in the air and shouting)* Stop the boat! *(actors react)* **(Chpt 19)** *(Mr. Wonka leaps from the boat)* This is the most important room in the entire factory! The Inventing Room! Not even an Oompa-Loompa has ever been allowed in here. *(He gets very excited)*

NARRATOR 1: Mr. Wonka [became] even more excited than usual. Anyone could see that this was the room he loved best of all.

WONKA: *(rushing to a machine that spits out a candy that looks like a marble; he grabs it up and holds it aloft)* Everlasting Gobstoppers! You can put it in your mouth and suck it and suck it and it will never get any smaller!

VIOLET: It's like gum!

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

WONKA: *(offended)* It is **NOT** like gum. If you tried chewing one of the Gobstoppers, you'd break your teeth off! *(But it gives him an idea. Excited again)* Now over here is something that I am terrifically proud of! **(Chpt 20)** *(He pushes some buttons on a machine and out comes a strip of gum; he holds it aloft)* Don't you know what it is?

VIOLET: By gum, it's gum! It's a stick of chewing-gum!

WONKA: **(Chpt 21)** This gum is my latest, my greatest, my most fascinating invention! It's a chewing-gum meal! A whole 3-course dinner all by itself.

VIOLET: Just so long as it's gum, that's for me! *(She takes her own gum out and sticks it behind her ear and grabs the new piece from Wonka's hand, pops it in her mouth and starts chewing)* It's tomato soup! Hot and creamy. I can feel it running down my throat.

WONKA: Stop! The gum isn't ready yet. There are still one or two things . . .

VIOLET: Roast beef! Tender and juicy. Baked potato filled with butter!

WONKA; No, no, no . . you musn't!

VIOLET: Blueberry pie! *(As she chews, she begins to plump up just like a giant blueberry)* I feel sick! *(She looks panicked)*

WONKA: *(with a heavy sigh)* It always goes wrong when we come to the desert. I've tried it twenty times on twenty Oompa-Loompas ad every one of them finished up as a blueberry. *(He snaps his fingers for an Oompa-Loompa)* Roll Miss Beauregarde to the Juicing room at once. We've got to squeeze the juice out of her immediately. *(He turns back to the tour)* **(Chpt 22)** Well, well, well . . . two naughty little children gone. I think we'd better get out of this room quickly before we lose anyone else!

*****

WONKA: **(Chpt 24)** All right, take a peek through the glass panel. But whatever you do, don't go into THE NUT ROOM! You'll disturb the squirrels.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

VERUCA: *(peering through the window she whines to her dad)* Squirrels!

WONKA: Specially trained squirrels for getting the nuts out of walnuts.

VERUCA: I want a squirrel! Get me one! I want a ***trained*** squirrel!

VERUCA'S DAD: *(pulling out his checkbook)* Very well, Wonka, how much d'you want for one of these squirrels? Name your price.

WONKA: They're not for sale. She can't have one.

VERUCA: Who says I can't! I'm going in to get myself one this very minute! *(She stomps off stage and we hear her scream)*

WONKA: *(Peering through the window)* Watch! They're testing her to see if she's a bad nut. *(Veruca screams off stage again) (Shaking his head)* My goodness, her head must have sounded quite hollow. She IS a bad nut. Down the rubbish chute *(Vercua screams again and it fades away)* Too late. She's gone!

VERUCA'S DAD: But where? What happens to the bad nuts? Where does the chute go?

WONKA: To the furnace, of course . . . but Don't worry. There's always a chance that they decided not to light it today.

VERUCA'S DAD: Now see here, Wonka. My daughter may be a frump – I don't mind admitting it – but that doesn't mean you can roast her to a crisp. I'm extremely cross about this, *(winks at Wonka)* I really am. *(celebrates silently as he turns away)*

*****

WONKA: **(Chpt 28)** *(Actor 1 portrays a humble Charlie listening respectfully)* We must get going! How many children are there left now?

GPJOE: But Mr. Wonka, there's only Charlie left now.

WONKA: You mean you're the only one left? *(pretending to be surprised)*

CHARLIE: Why, yes. Yes!

WONKA: My dear boy! That means you've won! *(He shakes Charlies hand furiously)* Well done, Charlie, well done! **(Chpt 30)** How I love my chocolate factory. Do

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

you love it too, Charlie?

CHARLIE: Oh, yes. I think it's the most wonderful place in the whole world!

WONKA: *(Wiping a tear from his eye)* I am very pleased to hear you say that. And now I shall tell you why. As soon as you are old enough, the entire factory will become yours! *(Charlie reacts)* I don't want a grown-up . . . I have to have a child to whom I can tell all my most precious secrets.

CHARLIE: So that is why you sent out the Golden Tickets?

WONKA: Exactly! I decided to invite children to the factory and the one I liked best would be the winner! We must fetch the rest of the family. They can all live in the factory from now on!

CHARLIE: The most wonderful place in the whole world!

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Roald Dahl
ISBN: 978-0142410318
Publisher: Puffin Books
Date (Month/Year): Aug 1983

AWARD HISTORY

2004 National Qualifier
2005 National Qualifier
2009 National Qualifier
2010 National Qualifier
2011 National Qualifier
2012 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2014 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier – MS
OH State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY